

Moving the Site Without Losing Google.

Replatforming **ascinternational.com** from WordPress to a new build — and keeping years of hard-won search rankings, AI-answer visibility, and structured-data value intact.

Focus: **Solder Paste Inspection & AOI**

Verified against **Google Search Central**

22 fact-checked findings

The one-line takeaway: **the page names don't have to match — the redirects do.** Do that one thing right and the move is safe.

START HERE

Do the page names matter?

"Should we rename the new site's pages to match the old ones?"

No — identical page names are **not** a Google ranking factor. What carries your rankings forward is a **301 redirect**.

Google's own migration documentation states it plainly: "301 and other permanent redirects don't cause a loss in PageRank." A 301 is a permanent "this page moved here" instruction. Set one up for every old address and Google quietly transfers years of ranking power to the new page — whatever you choose to name it.

OLD INDEXED PAGE
/smt-inspection/
solder-paste-inspection/

301 redirect



NEW PAGE (ANY NAME)
your new
cleaner URL

The redirect — not a matching name — is what moves the rankings. Menu wording like "Solutions" vs "Products" is purely a branding choice; Google ranks **URLs**, not menu labels.

The one scenario that wrecks it: wiping the old WordPress site with **no redirects**. Old URLs return "page not found," Google drops them, and the documented result is a **20–60% traffic loss within about two weeks**. That outcome is the downside of doing it *wrong* — and it is entirely preventable.

THE RISK, VISUALIZED

Two ways to launch. One cliff.

Same new site, same domain — the **only** variable is whether a complete redirect map exists before launch. This is the difference between a smooth move and a traffic emergency.

Projected organic traffic impact after launch

Launch with NO redirects

Old URLs 404 & get de-indexed

–20% to –60% ⚠️

Launch WITH redirect map

Each old URL → closest new page

≈ 0

Figures are directional, triangulated from Search Engine Journal, practitioner case studies, and Google Search Central. Recovery from a botched migration can take months; a clean migration typically shows little to no dip.



The #1 deliverable

A complete "old URL → new URL" map, built *before* anything changes. Sourced from the old sitemaps, Google Search Console, and backlink data so no high-value page is missed.

Build first

Then launch



Redirect to the closest match

Each old page points to its real equivalent — a product to a product, a guide to a guide. **Never** blanket-redirect everything to the homepage; Google treats that as a fake "not found" and the rankings are lost.

One hop

Relevant target

RECOMMENDATIONS

The plan, in priority order

1

Build the redirect map before launch

The single most important step. Pair every old indexed URL with its closest new page. This is the safety net that carries your rankings across.

2

Reuse the good old URLs where it's easy

Paths like */smt-inspection/solder-paste-inspection/* are already keyword-rich and proven. A URL you keep needs no redirect at all — zero risk. Only change one where there's a real reason.

3

Never funnel everything to the homepage

Each old page redirects to its real match. Homepage-dumping old URLs is a top migration mistake that quietly drains ranking power.

4

For AI search, skip the gimmicks

Google's official 2026 stance: "optimizing for generative AI search is still SEO." No *llms.txt*, no special markup. To get cited by ChatGPT & AI Overviews, open each page with a plain-English answer in the first ~150 words, then use clear headings, FAQ Q&A, and spec tables.

5

Lean into the single-topic focus

A site that's *only* about solder paste inspection & AOI builds exactly the "topical authority" Google rewards and gives AI engines clean expert passages to quote. Redirect old off-topic articles into relevant SPI/AOI content rather than carrying them over.

6

Keep schema — but right-size it

Organization, Product, FAQPage and BreadcrumbList markup earn rich results in classic Google. They're *helpful but not required* for AI citation — there, content quality is the real lever.

CHEAT SHEET

Do this. Not that.

 DO

- ✓ Build the complete redirect map **first**
- ✓ Reuse proven, keyword-rich old URLs
- ✓ Server-side render so Google sees content without JavaScript
- ✓ Give every page a unique title + meta description
- ✓ Submit the new sitemap in Search Console
- ✓ Keep the old site reachable so redirects can fire
- ✓ Watch for 404 errors for ~30 days after launch

 DON'T

- ✗ Wipe the old site with no redirects in place
- ✗ Redirect everything to the homepage
- ✗ Change URLs with no real reason
- ✗ Rely on *llms.txt* or AI-specific gimmicks
- ✗ Let pages load only via client-side JavaScript
- ✗ Strip out the page titles & descriptions Rank Math set
- ✗ Take the old domain offline too early



Getting cited by AI

AI engines pull and quote self-contained **passages**, not whole pages. Front-load the answer, write in clear Q&A blocks, and use your precise industry terms — "SPI," "AOI," "solder paste inspection." Jargon helps here.



The Next.js trap to avoid

The classic replatform failure is content that only appears after JavaScript runs — crawlers may miss it. Render pages on the server, and generate a real `sitemap.xml` and `robots.txt`.

Bottom line: this move is safe to make — *if* the redirect map exists before you flip the switch. The risk isn't the new site; it's launching without that map.

HOW WE KNOW THIS

Sources & verification

Findings were fan-out researched across 20 sources, then adversarially fact-checked — 22 claims confirmed, 3 weak claims discarded. Core conclusions rest on primary Google and Next.js documentation. ✓ FACT-CHECKED

- **Google Search Central** — Site moves with URL changes (primary source for the 301 / PageRank guidance)
- **Google Search Central** — AI features & your website / AI-optimization guide (May 2026): "optimizing for generative AI search is still SEO"
- **Search Engine Journal** — Website Migration Guide (checklist, soft-404 & traffic-loss evidence)
- **Next.js Official Docs** — SEO & Metadata (titles, JSON-LD, server rendering)
- **Practitioner case studies** — americaneagle, flyn.to, circlesstudio, refactor, paralleledevs (redirect-map & recovery-timeline corroboration)
- **GEO research** — "Generative Engine Optimization" peer-reviewed study + 2026 AI-citation analyses (front-loading, passage retrieval, E-E-A-T)

Note: exact percentages (e.g. "20–60% drop") are directional, not precise. AI-search guidance reflects Google's May 2026 documentation and should be re-checked periodically as the landscape evolves.

The very next step → build the redirect map

Pull the complete old-site URL list from all of ascinternational.com's sitemaps, lay it next to the new site's pages, and mark each one: **keep as-is**, **rename + redirect**, or **redirect to closest match**. That single document is what makes the whole move safe — and it can be built before a single page is touched.